

Measurements and shapes

Learner workbook

Describe size with an appropriate unit and pattern.

Understand the distinction

Use an adjective after the measurement: The table is two meters long. Use a noun with of: a length of two meters. In a compound adjective before a noun, the unit is singular: a two-meter table.

Choose the dimension you mean: long for length, wide for width, high or tall for height, and deep for depth. Tall is common for people and upright objects. Use square, round, or rectangular for shape. Always include the unit when a number alone is unclear.

Compare the patterns

AFTER THE NOUN

The cable is three meters long.

The measurement describes the cable.

BEFORE THE NOUN

It is a three-meter cable.

The unit stays singular in this compound adjective.

SHAPE

The table is rectangular.

Rectangular describes shape, not size.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Choose the correction: a five-meters cable

- A. a five-meter cable
- B. a five-metered cable
- C. a five-meters-long cable

2. Complete: The pool is two meters ____ . (depth / deep)

- A. deeply
- B. depth
- C. deep

3. What information is missing from The desk is 120 wide?

- A. The unit, such as centimeters.
- B. The desk's purchase date.
- C. An opinion about the desk's color.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. The desk is 120 centimeters wide and has a rectangular top. Which description is complete and grammatical?

- A. My desk is 120 centimeters width. Its top is rectangular.
- B. My desk is 120 wide. Its top is rectangular.
- C. My desk is 120 centimeters wide. Its top is rectangular.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. A. a five-meter cable

Use the singular unit in a compound adjective.

2. C. deep

An adjective follows this measurement.

3. A. The unit, such as centimeters.

The number needs a unit to be useful.

4. C. My desk is 120 centimeters wide. Its top is rectangular.

The description includes the value, measurement unit, and shape adjective.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-22.html